MONTHLY UPDATE

Kenya: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Standards · Public debate and participation in policymaking

FINANCE
New investments

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Data Storage · Energy · Technical Capacity · Cybersecurity

DPI
Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

DIGITALISATION
Digitalisation of sub-national government · Rural digital data capture

TECHNOLOGY
AI · ICT Industry · Innovation ecosystem

CAPACITY
Literacy · Training and skills · Research institutions

INCLUSION
Access to services · Digital divides

DATA
National statistics

GEOPOLITICS
US / hyperscaler activities

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

INVESTOR CONFIDENCE IN THE DIGITAL INVESTMENT CLIMATE

- **US tech giants flag Kenya investment risks** — Daily Nation, 10 September 2026

  Executives from four large United States technology and payments companies told a Nairobi business summit that unpredictable taxes, regulations and approvals could deter new capital from Kenya. They said investors need policy certainty to commit and expand, a warning aimed at the country's bid to be East Africa's digital investment hub.

NATIONAL COMMUNICATION POLICY: ENHANCING TRUST IN GOVERNMENT

- **One Government, One Voice: Isaboke on Kenya's new communication revolution** — The Star, 14 September 2026

  PS Isaboke on the new National Communication Policy: 21,500 digitised services against 353 in 2022, KES 6.4bn budget.

- **Gov't to tackle misinformation through coordinated communication as PS Isaboke unveils new measures to rebuild public trust - TV47 Digital** — TV47 Digital, 16 September 2026

  National Communication Policy 2026 in force: a strengthened information centre with AI sentiment analysis.

NATIONAL PAYMENT SYSTEM POLICY (DRAFT, AUGUST 2026)

- **Draft National Payment System Policy and National Payment System Bill, 2026** — Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's National Treasury and central bank published a draft National Payment System Policy and a draft National Payment System Bill, 2026 for public comment on 21 September 2026. The bill would replace the current Act and license payment providers and system operators by category, with minimum capital of Ksh5 million to Ksh250 million. It also requires interoperability, allows open-finance data sharing with consent and brings virtual asset providers that offer payments under the law, while the policy commits the government to a national instant payment switch.

- **Draft National Payment System Policy, August 2026** — The National Treasury, Republic of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's draft National Payment System Policy, dated August 2026, which identifies ten gaps in the current system. It commits to a national instant payment switch, requires open APIs and gives non-banks access to settlement. The consultation is summarised under the Treasury and central bank's joint release.

ACCESS TO INFORMATION POLICY

- **State vows proactive disclosure as Kenya marks access to information day** — The Star (Kenya), 27 September 2026

  PS Isaboke: new ATI Policy, focus now implementation; CAJ 2025 audit finds secrecy, weak records, digitisation gaps.

- **CS Kabogo gazettes new policy to boost public access to government information** — People Daily, 13 October 2026

  Kenya's ICT Cabinet Secretary gazetted the Access to Information Policy, 2026 on 9 October. It requires public offices to disclose key records proactively, answer requests within set timelines and give written reasons for refusals.

- **Kenya Has a New Law-Backed Plan to Force Public Offices to Release Records. Will It Work?** — Dawan Africa, 13 October 2026

  An explainer on Kenya's newly gazetted Access to Information Policy asks whether it will change practice: citizens already hold a right to request records, it notes, but often do not get them.

NATIONAL AI POLICY FOR SCIENCE, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION

- **Invitation for Public Participation in the Review of the Draft National AI Policy for Science, Research and Innovation and the Draft Science Diplomacy Policy** — State Department for Science, Research and Innovation (Kenya), 1 October 2026

  SDSRI public notice; comments due 14 Oct 2026; zero drafts of both policies posted on sri.go.ke.

Legislation and regulation

ACCESSION TO THE BUDAPEST CONVENTION ON CYBERCRIME

- **Accession to the Budapest Convention** — KICTANet, 1 September 2026

  Kenya seeks public views on joining the Budapest cybercrime convention by 11 September.

KENYA INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS REGULATIONS 2026

- **Register now: Validation forum on Kenya's draft ICT regulations (Sep 15–17)** — KICTANet, 1 September 2026

  Three-day virtual forum reviews 15 draft ICT regulations covering licensing to USF.

- **Ministry of ICT Hosts Stakeholder Workshop to Validate Proposed Kenya Information and Communications Regulations** — Uasin Gishu News, 23 September 2026

  Three-day validation with the Communications Authority; review spans licensing, spectrum, tariffs and domain names.

STANDALONE DATA-CENTRE LICENCE CATEGORY

- **Proposed Licensing Framework for Data Centres (Consultation Version)** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 1 September 2026

  CA's own text: KSh100,000 initial fee, 15-year term, standalone licence separating data centres from NFP-Tier 2.

- **Kenya Proposes Standalone Licence Framework for Data Centres** — Tech Africa News, 8 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya has proposed a standalone Data Centre licence for co-location operators, taking them out of the Network Facilities Provider-Tier 2 category they currently sit under, and opened comment for thirty days from its public notice. The Authority gives visibility over data-centre operations, support for investment and proportionality with comparable jurisdictions as its reasons; the notice itself is not held, so the closing date is unestablished.

- **Kenya proposes introduction of standalone data center license** — Connecting Africa, 10 September 2026

  Kenya's communications regulator opened a 30-day public consultation on a standalone licence for colocation data centres. It says the proposal would give greater regulatory clarity, improve visibility of data-centre operations and support investment, and it follows a broader overhaul of the telecommunications market framework begun in 2025.

NNAI RESOURCES FRAMEWORK CA.F.530:2026

- **Inside new rules for short codes, network equipment and mobile numbers announced by CA** — Pulse Kenya, 8 September 2026

  Kenya's Communications Authority issued an enhanced framework for numbering, naming, addressing and identification resources and opened consultations on network equipment specifications and on deactivating and recycling inactive numbers. Short codes move to allocation on a services basis rather than per operator, and the same set of notices carries the Authority's separate proposal for a standalone data centre licence category.

TECHNOPOLIS DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

- **Technopolis Development Authority Board fully constituted under new Act** — TechTrends Kenya, 14 September 2026

  Three appointments complete the board under the Technopolis Act 2026, in force since 2026-05-29.

NATIONAL PAYMENT SYSTEM BILL 2026

- **Draft National Payment System Policy and National Payment System Bill, 2026** — Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **The National Payment System Bill, 2026 (draft for comment)** — The National Treasury / Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  The full draft text of Kenya's National Payment System Bill, 2026, which runs to 79 clauses. It sets licence capital of Ksh5 million to Ksh250 million, requires interoperability, provides for open finance, brings virtual asset providers into scope and sets fines of up to Ksh20 million. The consultation is summarised under the Treasury and central bank's joint release.

- **Kenya: National Payment System Bill, 2026 proposes comprehensive overhaul of the payments regulatory framework** — Bowmans, 30 September 2026

  Law firm on draft Bill: 10 licence classes, capital Ksh5m-250m, open finance, no grandfathering; comments by 9 Oct.

CENTRAL BANK OF KENYA (NON-DEPOSIT TAKING CREDIT PROVIDERS) REGULATIONS, 2026

- **The Central Bank of Kenya (Non-Deposit Taking Credit Providers) Regulations, 2026 (Legal Notice No. 191 of 2026)** — Kenya Gazette Supplement No. 234 (Kenya Law), 29 September 2026

  Revokes 2022 DCP rules; Sh500,000 annual fee; express data-processing consent; AI lending decisions human-reviewed.

- **CBK raises compliance costs and tightens the rules governing Kenya's growing credit providers** — TechTrends KE, 5 October 2026

  Annual fee Sh20,000 to Sh500,000; Sh1m late charge; CBK approval for rate changes; 281 digital lenders licensed.

STATISTICS ACT 2006 (CAP. 112)

- **Senators push Bill to transform KNBS into Kenya Statistics Authority** — People Daily, 12 October 2026

  Senate finance committee review, 12 Oct 2026; county statistics offices; Ksh5m fines; independence doubts.

Data protection

SAFEGUARDS FOR DEACTIVATING AND RECYCLING TELEPHONE NUMBERS

- **Procedures and technical safeguards for deactivation and recycling of inactive telecommunication numbering resources (CA.G.520:2026, Version 1.0)** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 1 September 2026

  Kenya's draft numbering-recycling rules propose a *106# status check and Sept 19 start date.

- **Kenya's new phone number rules will make recycling costlier for telcos** — TechCabal, 2 September 2026

Kenya's Communications Authority published draft procedures for deactivating and recycling mobile numbers: deactivation only after three consecutive months without revenue-generating activity, then three further months of contact attempts by message and the details given at registration, with at-risk numbers published in national media. The document is out for consultation, with memoranda due 11 September 2026.

- **SIM deactivation now backed by law, CA says** — Daily Nation, 7 October 2026

  Kenya's communications regulator told a National Assembly committee that SIM deactivation and number recycling now run under its 2026 procedures: notice to the subscriber's contact after three months' inactivity, a public notice and status check before recycling after six, and whitelisting for subscribers who are sick, imprisoned or deceased. It was answering a petition against the largest operator's recycling.

- **CA to set up central database to track recycled phone numbers** — Daily Nation, 12 October 2026

  Kenya's communications regulator said it will set up a central database of recycled phone numbers, which operators must update every three months. Banks, fintechs and bulk message senders would check it before sending account messages to a number.

HIGH COURT RULING ON RIDE-HAILING DATA RETENTION

- **What High Court Ruling on Uber, Bolt and Other Ride-Hailing Taxi Mean for Kenya's Consumers** — Consumers Federation of Kenya (COFEK), 2 September 2026

  Kenya's High Court voids Uber/Bolt's 18% commission cap and a 3-year passenger-data retention rule.

GUIDANCE NOTES FOR CROSS-BORDER DATA TRANSFERS

- **Guidance Notes for Cross-border Data Transfers** — Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (Kenya), 8 September 2026

  Final issued text: Kassait foreword, compliance checklist, BCR application form, two sets of Standard Clauses.

DRAFT NOTICE ON ADDITIONAL CATEGORIES OF SENSITIVE PERSONAL DATA

- **DRAFT Public Notice: Additional Categories of Sensitive Personal Data (Data Protection Act, 2019, s.47) — PDF** — Office of the Data Protection Commissioner, 11 September 2026

  Political affiliation, trade union membership made sensitive only for cross-border inflows; s.47 draft open for comment.

MATEY V SAFARICOM RULING ON ACCESS TO DATA-DISCLOSURE RECORDS

- **Matey v Safaricom PLC (Constitutional Miscellaneous Application E043 of 2026) [2026] KEHC 13624 (KLR), Ruling, 18 September 2026** — High Court of Kenya at Nairobi (Milimani), Constitutional and Human Rights Division; text as reported by SheriaHub from Kenya Law, 18 September 2026

  Safaricom ordered to disclose access logs and data requests for Mar 2024-Jan 2025 within 21 days; Art. 35.

DATA-PROTECTION CERTIFICATE AS A CONDITION OF DIGITAL-LENDER LICENSING

- **Stakeholders push for data sovereignty as AI conference tackles power shortages, worker exploitation** — Citizen Digital, 25 September 2026

  ODPC certificate a CBK licensing precondition for digital lenders; Kenya 0.6% of global data-centre capacity.

DATA PROTECTION COMMISSIONER SUCCESSION

- **Kenya's Data Commissioner search comes as AI transforms data governance** — TechTrends KE, 30 September 2026

Kenya's Public Service Commission shortlisted 13 of 152 applicants to succeed Immaculate Kassait as Data Protection Commissioner at the end of her single six-year term, with interviews on 5 October 2026.

DATA BREACH SUIT AGAINST ABSA BANK KENYA

- **How Absa Bank's employee data leak brought down multi-billion business** — The Standard, 12 October 2026

  A former senior manager at a Kenyan bank testified, in a Sh1.5 billion data breach suit against it, that a credit manager disclosed a borrower's loan distress to a third party. He said the bank's legal department recommended no action because it saw no material risk of abuse.

Regional collaboration

CONTINENTAL BEHAVIOURAL INTELLIGENCE AND INFODEMIC MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

- **Africa CDC Calls for Stronger Community Engagement and Behavioural Intelligence to Boost Health Security** — Ommy Dallah, 3 September 2026 AFRICA

  Mombasa workshop harmonises a continental behavioural-intelligence and infodemic framework.

- **Africa CDC advances public health intelligence framework** — The Star (Kenya), 4 September 2026 AFRICA

  Africa CDC and member states validated components of a continental behavioural intelligence and infodemic management framework at a five-day meeting in Mombasa, with participants from six countries alongside the ECOWAS regional surveillance centre and the WHO Africa Infodemic Response Alliance. The framework is to turn community feedback, social listening, service-delivery and programme data and rapid research into decision-ready intelligence; Africa CDC states it is not another database or reporting platform.

MALABO CONVENTION RATIFICATION POSITION

- **Invitation: High-Level Malabo Convention Dialogue – Monday, 7th September 2026** — Kenya ICT Action Network (KICTANet), 4 September 2026

  Parliamentary breakfast dialogue, Nairobi, 7 Sep 2026, on Kenya's accession; MPs, ODPC and civil society.

KENYA-ARMENIA DIGITAL COOPERATION TALKS

- **Kenya and Armenia Explore Digital Cooperation in AI, Cloud and Youth Skills** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  Kenya and Armenia have opened discussions on cooperation in digital technologies, education, ICT, trade and investment, after a meeting between the ICT principal secretary and Armenia's ambassador. Artificial intelligence and cloud computing were identified as potential areas alongside youth skills; no instrument has been signed.

CROSS-BORDER DIGITAL PUBLIC SERVICE PILOT AMONG AFRICAN UNION STATES

- **UNGA81: Kenya proposes cross-border digital public service pilot for Africa** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

  ICT Cabinet Secretary William Kabogo proposed that willing African Union member states jointly pilot one cross-border public service and report back by February 2027. He made the proposal at an AUC-Google ministerial roundtable in New York, pointing to eCitizen's more than 22,500 services and Kenya's Government Interoperability Framework.

DIGITAL COOPERATION ORGANIZATION MEMBERSHIP

- **Kenya Signs DCO Charter on the Sidelines of UNGA81** — African Eye Report (DCO announcement), 28 September 2026

  Kabogo signs in New York; Kenya one of eight approved candidates taking DCO from 16 to 24 members.

Standards

NATIONAL INFORMATION SECURITY FRAMEWORK AUDIT AND RISK TOOLKITS

- **ICT Authority steps up protection of Govt systems, critical information infrastructure** — Education News (Kenya), 7 September 2026

  Kenya's technology authority put the National Information Security Framework's audit, risk-management and certification mechanisms to a Nairobi stakeholder workshop, to establish whether they are practical for national implementation ahead of certifying critical information infrastructure. The framework text and the certification criteria are not published.

CENTRAL BANK GUIDANCE NOTE ON AI FOR THE BANKING SECTOR

- **Central Bank of Kenya - Bank Supervision Annual Report 2025** — Central Bank of Kenya, 22 September 2026

  AI survey Mar 2025: 50% adoption, 30% with AI strategies, credit risk top use; AI guidance note planned.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

CIVIL-SOCIETY POSITION ON DIGITAL TAXATION

- **Why Kenyan Creators Are Pushing Back on the YouTube Tax** — KICTANet, 2 September 2026

  Kenyan creators are contesting the withholding tax on video-platform earnings, which sits alongside the digital services tax, value-added tax on digital marketplace supply and the digital asset tax. The civil-society network carrying the campaign published its own brief on digital-tax reform in 2024.

LITIGATION OVER THE DIGITAL SUPERHIGHWAY TENDERS

- **Why High Court quashed Attorney General's opinion on Digital Superhighway tender** — Pulse Kenya, 4 September 2026

  High Court voids the 2024 advisory clearing the Sh15bn Nightigale tender; conflict question goes to EACC.

- **High Court nullifies Attorney General's opinion on which Communications Authority relied upon to pay its former Chairperson Mary Wambui Mungai** — Consumers Federation of Kenya (COFEK), 4 September 2026

  COFEK's own account of the ruling quashing the AG's opinion on the Nightigale Digital Superhighway tender.

HERSPACE KENYA

- **HerSpace Kenya: A New Initiative to Confront Technology-Facilitated Gender-Based Violence** — KICTANet, 25 September 2026

  Two-year Co-Impact-backed programme; 2023 KICTANet study found 54% of women respondents had faced TFGBV.

Finance

New investments

KENYA DIGITAL ECONOMY ACCELERATION PROJECT

- **Kenya Accelerates Digital Economy Investments Under KDEAP** — Tukio, 14 September 2026

  Digital Smartboards reach 10,384 junior schools in all 47 counties and 62,364 teachers trained under KDEAP.

- **Kenya, World Bank Take Stock of Digital Economy Project KDEAP's Gains and Challenges** — Ecofin Agency, 15 September 2026

  A 2025 aide-memoire put KDEAP at 8 of 25 indicators met and $10.6m disbursed, 3.1% of the $390m appraised.

NATIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE FUND

- **MPs find gaps in the rules for the KES 340 billion fund built from the Safaricom sale** — Tech-ish, 14 September 2026

  Finance committee wants a near-total rewrite of the investment policy for the KES 340bn Safaricom-sale fund.

- **Sh320bn raised for National Infrastructure Fund, Ruto says** — The Star, 15 September 2026

  The president said about Sh320bn has been raised for the National Infrastructure Fund, which is now established in law with its top management appointed and its investment policy framework complete. The money is to finance roads, energy and water.

- **Vodacom's Safaricom deal struck down by Kenyan high court** — TechCentral, 15 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  KSh204.3bn for the 15% stake, KSh40.2bn dividend advance, KSh244.5bn total, KSh340bn now in the fund.

DIGIKEN LOAN PORTFOLIO GUARANTEE WITH A COMMERCIAL BANK

- **Co-op Bank, UNCDF launch financing facility to boost Kenya's digital** — Bizna Kenya, 24 September 2026

  Co-operative Bank of Kenya and UNCDF launched a US$900,000 loan portfolio guarantee under the DigiKen programme, backing up to US$1.8 million of lending to fintechs, digital credit providers, e-commerce and digitally enabled small firms, and innovation hubs. UNCDF covers 50% of outstanding principal, rising to 70% for borrowers in the Arid and Semi-Arid Lands.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

BROADBAND SUBSCRIPTIONS REPORTED BY THE COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR

- **Ruto's 100,000km fibre optic network plan falters** — Daily Nation, 2 September 2026

  37,000km laid of the 100,000km target, 63,000km outstanding months before the 2027 deadline.

- **Kenya's fixed internet market grows 32% as fibre expands** — TechTrendsKE, 19 September 2026

  Fibre 1.57m (+29.7%), Starlink 27,616, international bandwidth 28,950 Gbps, DSL down to 23, at 30 June 2026.

DIGITAL SUPERHIGHWAY FIBRE AND HOTSPOT TARGETS

- **Ruto's 100,000km fibre optic network plan falters** — Daily Nation, 2 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **Govt steps up Digital Superhighway implementation** — People Daily, 4 September 2026

  PSs Isaboke and Tanui co-chair an agency review; government targets tech industry growth from $7bn to $100bn.

ALINET SOLAR-POWERED COMMUNITY NETWORK, SIPILI

- **Seeding change: A solar-powered community network shaping meaningful connectivity in Kenya** — Association for Progressive Communications (APC), 9 September 2026

  ALIN East Africa runs the Sipili community network on solar to survive outages, voltage swings and equipment damage.

LULU COASTAL CABLE SYSTEM

- **Kenya coast gets first protected subsea cable, LuLu** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026

  A consortium unveiled the LuLu Coastal Cable System at ITW Africa 2026, presented as the first fully protected submarine cable dedicated to Kenya's Indian Ocean coastline: 500km linking five landing points from Mombasa to Lamu, including Vipingo Special Economic Zone, Kilifi and Malindi, pairing a seabed cable with a parallel protected terrestrial route. It is specified at 144 fibres and up to 60Tbps per fibre pair over a 25-year design life, with service targeted for the second quarter of 2028 subject to contract execution, and the Mombasa landing connecting it to cables already landed at the port. The co-developers named are INDOI of Mauritius, Blue Trade Investments as the Kenya-registered landing party, ARISE IIP, AfriTrade Consulting Group and Kingdom Bank; no project value or financing structure is stated.

- **New submarine cable puts Kenya's Coast on digital growth path** — The Standard, 10 September 2026

  A planned submarine cable would link Mombasa to Lamu through five landing points along Kenya's coastline, with a parallel terrestrial route to keep services running if the seabed link is disrupted. The developers say it will extend resilient connectivity along 500 kilometres of coast and support data centres, cloud services and technology businesses; the consortium is anchored on the Vipingo special economic zone.

PARATUS GOMA-TO-MOMBASA TERRESTRIAL FIBRE ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 DRC RWANDA UGANDA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

AIRTEL KENYA TELESONIC WHOLESALE FIBRE SUBSIDIARY

- **Airtel Africa Shuts Down Kenya Fiber Unit After Two Years** — Techweez, 14 September 2026

  Airtel Africa is winding up Airtel Kenya Telesonic, its wholesale fibre subsidiary, two years after launch, with a KES 16.1 million loss and no revenue in 2025. Its facilities licence was returned to the Communications Authority in February, with gazettement pending.

FRAMEWORK AGREEMENTS FOR NATIONAL BACKBONE AND CROSS-BORDER LINKS

- **Request for Bids KE-ICTA-538567-NC-RFB — Framework Agreements for Extending National Backbone and Cross Border Links (Lot 1, Lot 2)** — ICT Authority (Kenya), 15 September 2026

  Full bidding document for Kenya's KDEAP backbone framework agreements; bids close 29 October 2026.

- **Kenya floats tender for national fibre backbone, cross-border links** — TechTrends Kenya, 16 September 2026

Kenya's backbone tender will be scored 80% on technical factors and 20% on cost, with winning bidders required to disclose beneficial ownership. Public-sector fibre stood at 30,454km in 2026, up from 22,486km in 2022.

- **Kenya ICTA Opens Tender to Expand National Fibre and Cross-Border Connectivity** — Tech Africa News, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT Authority opened an international tender to extend the national fibre backbone and cross-border and metro links under the World Bank-backed digital economy project, which TechAfricaNews says is financed by US$390 million in World Bank credits.

- **Kenya opens fibre backbone tender** — ITWeb Africa, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's ICT Authority tendered two framework agreements, national backbone links and cross-border and metro links, each for three years extendable by two. Treasury puts the public-sector fibre network at 30,454km against a 100,000km target before the 2027 election.

- **Kenya Allocates KSh 13 Billion to Expand Fibre Network by 27,000 Kilometres** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026

  Kenya will put KSh 13 billion into extending its national fibre backbone and cross-border links by at least 27,000 km, the ICT principal secretary told a pre-bid session. Gaps are to be allocated by reverse auction to draw matching private capital.

STARLINK KENYA FIXED BROADBAND

- **Kenya's fixed internet market grows 32% as fibre expands** — TechTrendsKE, 19 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

GUIDELINES FOR COMMERCIAL INTERNET TELEPHONY SERVICES

- **Kenya CA Moves to Finalise Guidelines for Commercial Internet Telephony Services** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Kenya's Communications Authority invited stakeholders to validate its draft guidelines for commercial internet telephony services, after reviewing responses to an earlier consultation. The guidelines set the technical and operational terms for rolling out such services.

SATELLITE FREQUENCY LICENSING FRAMEWORK, 2026

- **Stakeholder Consultation on the Satellite Frequency Licensing Framework** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 13 October 2026

  Draft spectrum rules for GSO and NGSO services; landing rights prerequisite; terminal records; comments by 6 Nov.

Data Storage

NBO2 DATA CENTRE, NAIROBI CAMPUS

- **Digital Realty Strengthens Nairobi as East Africa Digital Gateway with New Data Center** — Digital Realty, 7 September 2026

  A second facility on the operator's Nairobi campus adds 6.4MW of capacity, opened alongside the retirement of the iColo brand in Kenya and Mozambique in favour of the parent's. The figure is critical IT load rather than delivered live load, and no occupancy or campus total is published.

- **Government welcomes digital investors** — The Standard, 7 September 2026

  PS John Tanui at the NBO2 launch: Kenya working on the policy space to stay attractive to digital investors.

- **Firm bolsters East Africa's tech hub with data centre** — The Standard, 8 September 2026

  NBO2 in Karen adds 6.4 MW to the Nairobi campus: 34,000 sqm, over 14 MW total IT power, six data halls, LEED Silver.

NOBUS NAIROBI AVAILABILITY ZONE

- **Nobus Opens Nairobi Availability Zone** — CIO Africa, 9 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Nobus Cloud Services, a Nigerian public cloud provider operated from Lagos, went live with a Nairobi availability zone designated Nobus-EA-AZ1, letting Kenyan organisations provision workloads locally. It opened alongside a programme offering free cloud credits and technical support to African startups and enterprises.

OFFSHORE ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE DATA CENTRE AT MOMBASA

- **Greek firm Amaco partners with US energy giant for Sh194bn Mombasa data centre** — Business Daily Africa, 10 September 2026

  A Greek energy group has partnered with a United States energy-equipment company to supply gas turbines for its proposed US$1.5 billion artificial-intelligence data centre at Mombasa. The turbines would sit in an unmotorised floating power barge feeding local or national grids, and the facility is intended to serve East African demand for computing infrastructure.

TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES SOVEREIGN CLOUD AT IXAFRICA

- **TCS Sovereign Cloud Goes Live In Nairobi** — CIO Africa, 28 September 2026

  Tata Consultancy Services' sovereign cloud went live in Kenya, hosted at iXAfrica's Nairobi campus and delivered with a regional integrator, aimed at government agencies and regulated sectors with data-residency rules. Its capacity, pricing and clients were not disclosed.

Energy

EMERGENT GRID COMPUTE-ANCHORED MINI-GRID DEMONSTRATION

- **The Rockefeller Foundation and Mission 300 Accelerator Launch Demonstration to Test Whether AI Demand Can Help Finance Energy Access in Africa** — The Rockefeller Foundation, 24 September 2026 DRC SIERRA LEONE AFRICA

  Compute as mini-grid anchor customer; Kenya, DRC, Sierra Leone pilots for about 85,000 people; community load first.

Technical Capacity

KENYA ADVANCED INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

- **Kenya, South Korea Deepen Ksh129.4B development partnership** — People Daily Digital, 11 September 2026

  Kiptoo meets Korea Eximbank in Seoul, 2026-09-10; KAIST complete, Konza Digital Media City newly approved.

Cybersecurity

CYBER THREAT EVENTS RECORDED BY THE COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR

- **Web attacks up 44pc as hackers target State, ISP systems** — Daily Nation, 3 September 2026

  Web application attacks up 43.7% in the quarter to June 2026; 2.36bn threat events, down 30.03%.

GUIDE TO THE INVESTIGATION AND PROSECUTION OF CYBERCRIME

- **Investigation and Prosecution of Offences Under the Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act, Cap 79C: A Rapid Reference Guide** — National Computer and Cybercrimes Coordination Committee (NC4), with the Office of the Director of Public Prosecutions and the National Police Service, Kenya, 3 September 2026

  29 offence heads with elements and evidence, 30 sample charges, seven court application templates.

- **Kenya unveils guide to standardise cybercrime investigation and prosecution** — The Star (Kenya), 3 September 2026

  76 offences and sample cases, a common framework under the Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act.

NATIONAL CYBERSECURITY AGENCY

- **Safer cyberspace beckons as State firms up oversight agency** — The Star, 11 September 2026

  Director General recruited and deployed; board and technical posts outstanding under Legal Notice No. 89 of 2026.

- **CSs, CJ Koome Make New Appointments as Lorna Ogolla Joins NCA** — Kenyans.co.ke, 12 September 2026

  Gazette notice of 2026-09-11 names Lorna Ogolla Omondi and Jerop Joy Kibor to the NCA board.

- **Kenya Appoints Two Members To National Cybersecurity Agency Board** — CIO Africa, 14 September 2026

  Gazette Notice 14420 under the State Corporations (NCA) Order 2026 dates the appointments to 2026-09-11.

NATIONAL COMPUTER INCIDENT RESPONSE CENTRE'S DIGITAL FORENSICS LABORATORY

- **Govt steps up safety against cybersecurity and data privacy** — The Standard, 7 October 2026

  Kenya's ICT minister told the Senate that the national incident response centre's digital forensics laboratory has received more than 200 investigation requests, most involving online abuse. A working group on online safety, a national referral directory and a review of gaps in the law have been agreed.

DPI

Data Exchange

REVENUE-AUTHORITY ENFORCEMENT OF A THIRD COUNTRY'S IMPORT E-PERMIT CHARGE

- **On The Spot: URA Links With US-Sanctioned South Sudan Firm Crawford Capital Raises Concern - The Capital Times** — The Capital Times, 1 September 2026 SOUTH SUDAN UGANDA

  URA and KRA still enforce Crawford Capital's e-Permit collections at borders after the 12 May 2026 US sanctions.

PESALINK AND PAPSS INTERLINK

- **ABC Bank Connects Customers to 190+ African Banks Through PAPSS Payment Network** — Soko Directory, 3 September 2026

  Kenyan bank live on PAPSS: 28 countries, 190+ banks, 16 switches; KES or USD settlement.

- **PAPSS payments grew 1,000% in a year, and Kenya is now on the network** — tech-ish, 17 September 2026 AFRICA

Payments across the pan-African settlement network are reported to have grown about tenfold over the year while the average payment fell to about a fifth of its level a year earlier — many small transfers in place of a few large ones. Kenya's national switch is the first of its kind piloted for termination on the network.

UNIFIED VERIFICATION OF PUBLIC SERVANTS' ACADEMIC CERTIFICATES

- **Government Plans Unified System to Verify Public Servants' Certificates - Nairobi Wire** — Nairobi Wire, 18 September 2026

  Kenya's head of public service convened the public service commission, the examinations council and the education ministry to build a single mechanism linking academic credential databases to hiring agencies, to cut verification delays and fake certificates. No design or date is set.

MASTERKEY DIGITAL SKILLS AND WORK WALLET

- **Kenyan President Ruto names Ghana among first countries for portable skills programme** — Graphic Online, 22 September 2026 GHANA RWANDA

  Verifiable skills-and-work wallet; Ghana, Rwanda, Kenya in phase one, 150,000 placements; Kenya's wallet via eCitizen.

SECOND KENYA SOCIAL ECONOMIC INCLUSION PROJECT

- **Govt Moves to Link SHA, NSSF With Social Protection Database** — Kenyans.co.ke, 22 September 2026

  ESR and CDMIS upgrade to exchange data with SHA, NSSF and IPRS; consultant sought under World Bank-funded KSEIP-2.

UNIFIED OPERATIONS PLATFORM LINKING GOVERNMENT SYSTEMS

- **Kenya Has 22,000 Digital Services but Still Face a Manual Backend** — Techweez, 23 September 2026

  22,000 online services on a manual backend; Enterprise Architecture launched, interoperability platform in build.

- **State plans unified platform to link government systems** — TechTrendsKE, 23 September 2026

  WSO2Con Africa, 23 Sep 2026: secure-API Enterprise Platform, agentic AI and Zero Trust planned for public services.

VOTER REGISTER VERIFICATION AGAINST THE CIVIL IDENTITY REGISTER

- **IEBC turns to ID data to meet voter targets** — Daily Nation, 8 October 2026

  Census model dropped for NRB and immigration ID data; 6.3 million new-voter target for 2027.

Digital Identity and CRVS

REMOVAL OF EXTRA ID VETTING IN BORDER COUNTIES

- **600,000 secure IDs after government drops extra vetting in border counties** — Radio Generation Kenya, 17 September 2026

  NRB puts registrations since border-county vetting ended at over 600,000; first-time ID applications free.

- **End ID vetting for good, rights groups urge government** — The Star, 17 September 2026

  Five rights groups want the end of ID vetting written into law before the 2027 election.

DIGITAL BIRTH-NOTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **Kenya's digital birth registration platform enrols 270k newborns in two months** — Biometric Update, 21 September 2026

  270,000 newborns given UPIs in two months since the June launch; 2.4m national IDs issued January-September 2026.

- **State to Expand Digital Birth Registration to SHA Hospitals Within 3 Months** — Kenyans.co.ke, 6 October 2026

  Kenya will extend electronic birth notification to every hospital contracted by the Social Health Authority within three months, by December 2026, the immigration principal secretary said. Newborns notified this way receive a Unique Personal Identifier, and talks with the health ministry on linking civil registration to hospital systems are complete.

- **Kenya to introduce electronic birth notifications in three counties from Mashujaa Day** — TechTrendsKE, 14 October 2026

  Three-county pilot from 20 Oct 2026, then SHA hospitals within three months; paper notification replaced.

DIGITAL LIVE CAPTURE DEVICES FOR IDENTITY ISSUANCE

- **Bungoma ID registration hampered by staff, vehicle and equipment shortages** — Vivid Voice News, 3 October 2026

  Two ageing vehicles for the county; 19,361 registrations Jul-Sep 2026; ID cards take three weeks to a month from Nairobi.

- **Parliament probes delays in issuance of IDs, birth certificates in Elgeyo Marakwet** — People Daily, 5 October 2026

  IDs take one to two months against a two-week standard; Sh10,000 fuel a quarter; rejected applicants given no reasons.

Digital Payments and Fintech

KENYAN BANK PARTICIPATION IN PAPSS

- **ABC Bank goes live on intra-African pay system** — Business Today Kenya, 7 September 2026 AFRICA

  Kenyan bank live on PAPSS to 28 countries and over 190 banks, with a choice of shilling or recipient-currency settlement.

- **PAPSS goes live at I&M Bank Kenya to expand cross-border payments** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026 AFRICA

  The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System went live for customers of I&M Bank Kenya, the second Kenyan bank on the network. Customers can send to participating African markets in Kenyan shillings through the bank's branches rather than converting into an international currency; no volume, fee or corridor detail was published.

ACCESS TO CROSS-BORDER CONSUMER PAYMENT PLATFORMS

- **The platforms that help Kenyans get paid are changing the rules** — TechCabal, 8 September 2026

  The cross-border routes Kenyans use to be paid narrowed one by one over the past year: an international payments provider restricted accounts, a dollar-banking service closed, a remittance wallet paused and a streaming platform ended creator monetisation.

MERCHANT PAYMENT-INTEGRATION TOOL

- **Kenya : Kopo Kopo lance une nouvelle solution pour simplifier les paiements** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026

  A Kenyan technology company has launched an updated payment-integration tool letting businesses embed settlement options directly in their own software, merchant sites and mobile applications. It says more than 40,000 merchants can now automate refunds, send grouped payments and process transactions faster.

MOBILE MONEY MARKET SHARE

- **Fourth Quarter Sector Statistics Report for the Financial Year 2025/2026 (1st April - 30th June 2026)** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 17 September 2026

  Mobile money subscriptions 54.0m, mobile subscriptions 88.0m at 30 June 2026; the primary behind the agent-exit figures.

- **Airtel's virtual card will test Safaricom's grip on Kenya's online payments** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026

  Airtel Money plans to launch a Mastercard prepaid virtual card linked to its wallets in Kenya, competing with Safaricom's M-PESA GlobalPay. Communications Authority figures put M-PESA's mobile money share at 88.8% and Airtel Money's at 11.1% in June 2026; Airtel has issued more than 875,000 virtual cards in Uganda, Zambia and Tanzania since 2025.

MOBILE MONEY SUBSCRIPTIONS AND AGENTS

- **Fourth Quarter Sector Statistics Report for the Financial Year 2025/2026 (1st April - 30th June 2026)** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 17 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **Kenya Mobile Money Accounts Hit 54 Million Even as More Than 34,000 Agents Exit the Market** — Dawan Africa, 18 September 2026

  Kenya's regulator put mobile money subscriptions at 54,005,800 at the end of June 2026, up 1.2 per cent in the quarter and 13.2 per cent on the year, while more than 34,000 registered agents left the market in the same three months. Subscriptions count accounts, not people.

CBK NATIONAL SWITCH AND FAST PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **Draft National Payment System Policy, August 2026** — The National Treasury, Republic of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

KCB GROUP ACQUISITION OF A STAKE IN PESAPAL

- **Tanzania regulator reveals KCB's 22.23% stake in payments firm Pesapal** — TechCabal, 22 September 2026
  TANZANIA

  Tanzania's Fair Competition Commission put KCB Group's stake in Kenyan payments firm Pesapal at 22.23%, the first public figure for a deal KCB announced in 2025 without terms. The stake gives KCB indirect control of Pesapal Tanzania and is under the commission's review; its value is undisclosed.

KENSWITCH DOMESTIC CARD SCHEME

- **Kenswitch enters Kenya's card market with domestic card scheme** — TechCabal, 24 September 2026

Kenswitch, Kenya's largest independent payments switch, launched a domestic card scheme on 22 September that lets banks and other institutions issue physical and virtual cards on its network of more than 2,200 ATMs, 50,000 point-of-sale terminals and 80,000 agent outlets. It named no issuers, launch dates or pricing against Visa and Mastercard.

REGISTERED MOBILE-MONEY ACCOUNTS AND AGENTS

- **The Next Wave: Kenya's payments revolution cannot end with mobile money** — TechCabal, 27 September 2026

  A commentary argues that Kenya's success with mobile money has left the rest of its payments system neglected, citing central bank figures of 94.35 million registered accounts and KES 728.7 billion moved in July 2026. It calls for attention to bank rails, cards and cross-border payments beyond the dominant wallet.

DIGITAL CREDIT PROVIDER LICENSING

- **Kenya licenses 29 new digital lenders** — ITWeb Africa, 30 September 2026

  Trade-press report of the Central Bank of Kenya's licensing of 29 more digital lenders, summarised under the bank's own press release.

- **Press Release: Licensing of Digital Credit Providers** — Central Bank of Kenya, 30 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Kenya licensed 29 more digital credit providers, bringing the total to 281, from more than 900 applications since March 2022. Licensed lenders had made 9,596,509 loans worth Ksh165.1 billion by August 2026.

M-PESA TAP-TO-PAY AND QR ON PESAPAL TERMINALS

- **Safaricom taps Pesapal's 30,000 POS terminals to take M-PESA contactless** — TechCabal, 1 October 2026

  Safaricom and Pesapal put M-PESA tap-to-pay and QR payment on Pesapal's 30,000 point-of-sale terminals in Kenya, with no extra fee. Safaricom says scan-to-pay is live at more than 60,000 merchant outlets and targets 500,000 within a year.

EMMA WALLET (FINSERVE AFRICA)

- **The strategy behind Equity Bank's new digital wallet** — TechCabal, 6 October 2026

  Equity Bank's fintech arm, Finserve Africa, has launched a wallet called EMMA, reached by Android application, short code or the Equitel SIM toolkit and opened with an identity document and a facial check. Users can send money to M-PESA merchants, Airtel Money and bank accounts; the analysis reads it as the bank's bid to keep everyday payments, and the data behind them, on its own platform.

PESALINK ID ACCOUNT ALIAS

- **PesaLink's New ID Makes Bank Transfers Easier. The Bigger Question Is Who Owns the Rail.** — Fintech Association of Kenya (LinkedIn), 8 October 2026

  Kenya's bank-owned instant payment switch says a portable identifier is ready, so a sender need not know the recipient's bank, and institutions must now map customers to it. A fintech association asks who will own the rail as the alias takes hold.

AIRTEL MONEY VIRTUAL CARD

- **Airtel's virtual card will test Safaricom's grip on Kenya's online payments** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

M-PESA GLOBALPAY VIRTUAL CARD

- **Airtel's virtual card will test Safaricom's grip on Kenya's online payments** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

Registries

NATIONAL ADDRESSING SYSTEM FOR KENYA (NASK)

- **Kenya and Lesotho Deepen ICT Regulatory Cooperation on National Addressing System** — Tech Africa News, 2 September 2026 LESOTHO

  Kenya's Communications Authority is hosting a Lesotho Communications Authority delegation to benchmark Kenya's National Addressing System and the legal framework behind it. Kenya's system is designed to give every street, building and parcel of land a verifiable address, supporting last-mile e-commerce delivery and emergency response, and the authority has driven the draft National Addressing System Bill, 2025 with standards developed jointly with the Kenya Bureau of Standards. No visit dates are stated.

ARDHISASA LAND PLATFORM

- **LSK demands urgent restoration of Ardhisasa platform amid land transaction delays** — The Eastleigh Voice, 3 September 2026

  Land platform down since 1 September 2026, conveyancing stalled, no explanation or restoration timeline.

- **Concern as Govt Land Platform Goes Down, Kenyans Face Service Disruption** — Kenyans.co.ke, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's ArdhiSasa land platform announced an outage on 21 September 2026 affecting searches, transfers, title and lease registration, and stamp duty and land-rent payments, with no time given for restoring service. The Law Society of Kenya had already complained that the platform was unavailable from 1 September.

Sectoral management information systems

TRACK AND TRACE SYSTEM FOR THE HEALTH-PRODUCTS SUPPLY CHAIN

- **Kenya Steps Up Preparations for Extraordinary African Manufacturing Summit** — Ministry of Health (Kenya), 1 September 2026

  Extraordinary Summit set for 3-5 December 2026, Track and Trace to digitise the health-products supply chain.

SOCIAL HEALTH AUTHORITY CLAIMS PLATFORM

- **National and County Governments Strengthen Coordination on Health Reforms** — Ministry of Health, Kenya, 3 September 2026

  SHA claims settled at 78% across 47 counties, KSh 159.3bn paid; 7,789 UHC staff to permanent terms.

KENYA EDUCATION MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **The NEMIS to KEMIS Dilemma: How Kenya's School Data Overhaul Is Colliding With Grade 10 Selection** — Techweez, 9 September 2026

  PAC questions PS Ololtuaa after a capitation round used neither system; KES 103.99bn flagged on unverified NEMIS numbers.

SOCIAL HEALTH AUTHORITY CENTRALISED PROVIDER ONBOARDING

- **SHA Sets Out Requirements for Healthcare Providers Seeking New Contracts** — Tukio, 14 September 2026

Contracting from 2026-10-01 to 2029-06-30 runs through a Centralised Digital Platform and requires a working EMR.

- **SHA launches e-contracting portal for healthcare providers as new applications open** — People Daily, 18 September 2026

  Portal live 3pm EAT 2026-09-17 for four SHA funds; pre-launch test applications archived, fresh filings required.

- **Kenya Ministry of Health unveils E-contracting Platform in Nairobi** — HealthCare Middle East & Africa, 20 September 2026

  HAKIKA 2026–2029 cycle: claims timelines, downtime safeguards, tariffs mirrored in SHA systems; move by 1 Oct.

- **Social Health Authority (Kenya) - HAKIKA Healthcare Provider Contract Pack, 2026-2029 contracting cycle (revised, Parts A, B1, B2, B3)** — Social Health Authority (Kenya), 28 September 2026

  Parts B1-B3 text: real-time recording on SHA platform, DHA-certified EHIS, 7-day e-claims; Part A scan only.

- **Duale and Governors Set 14 October Deadline for SHA Facility Contracts** — Kenya Ministry of Health, 5 October 2026

  Joint communique with Council of Governors; 30 days for ODPC and other papers; clean claims paid within 90 days.

MIGRATION OF CONTRACTED HEALTH FACILITIES FROM THE INSURER'S PROVIDER PORTAL TO THE HEALTH MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **Duale orders health facilities to switch to SHA digital system by September 30** — The Star (Kenya), 29 September 2026

  Portal closes 30 Sept; level 2-4 public hospitals moved; 530 of 876 faith-based facilities transacting on HMIS.

- **Duale grants one month extension for SHA – HMIS transition** — Kenya Broadcasting Corporation, 1 October 2026

  Deadline moved to 30 Oct 2026 for Level 5-6, faith-based and private facilities; 38 of 518 FBOs transitioned.

- **Why SHA is shifting hospitals from portal to HMIS, Duale explains** — The Standard, 2 October 2026

  Why: hospitals ran two systems; 28 private HMIS certified by DHA; 4 Level 5 migrated, 23 in progress; deadline 30 Oct.

- **New SHA payment system: Why hospitals have a problem with Duale's plan** — Daily Nation, 3 October 2026

  Afya House meeting 2 Oct; owners bear certified-HMIS cost, up to Sh1m a year; facility-by-facility plan agreed.

- **CS Duale Calls for Timely Transition to HMIS and SHA Contracting** — Kenya Ministry of Health, 6 October 2026

  Kenya's health cabinet secretary urged providers to meet the timelines for moving from the insurer's provider portal to the health management information system and for completing the 2026-2029 contracting cycle. The ministry puts migration at 6,427 public facilities, 38 certified private facilities and 38 of 518 faith-based ones, and says correctly submitted claims will still be paid during the change.

DCI BIOMETRIC IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM FOR POLICE CLEARANCE (MBIS)

- **DCI rolls out biometric clearance to diplomats** — The Standard, 14 October 2026

  Kenya's Directorate of Criminal Investigations extended its biometric police clearance certificate service to diplomats. The MBIS system behind it, launched on 23 July, linked 26 of 63 application centres by September; the DCI says processing has fallen from 14 days to same-day.

MURANG'A COUNTY AFYAKE MEDICAL RECORDS SYSTEM

- **Kang'ata accuses State of putting lives at risk with AfyaKE shutdown** — The Standard, 15 October 2026

  Murang'a's governor accused Kenya's national government of switching off the county's AfyaKE digital health system to force it onto another platform, leaving patient records from 2023 inaccessible and services scaled down. Claims the county had uploaded to the Social Health Authority are reported missing. See the health ministry's denial under the same heading.

- **MoH denies tampering with Murang'a County's health portal** — Citizen Digital, 15 October 2026

  Kenya's Ministry of Health denied switching off Murang'a County's AfyaKE electronic medical records system. The health cabinet secretary called the system a private arrangement between the county and its developers and said neither had sought certification from the Digital Health Agency; the county says it has run in 165 facilities since 2023.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ITAX

- **MONARI: When iTax fails, the taxpayer still pays** — The Star, 1 September 2026

  A column on Kenya's tax portal failing on the evening of the 30 June filing deadline, when the revenue authority itself notified a traffic surge and intermittent delays. The penalties for late filing continued to run.

UNRECONCILED GAP IN THE SERVICE PLATFORM'S REPORTED COLLECTIONS

- **eCitizen under scrutiny over Sh36.5bn collections gap** — Radio Generation Kenya, 2 September 2026

  Auditor-General matched only Sh64.30bn of Sh100.84bn eCitizen collections reported for FY2023/24.

INTEGRATED ELECTIONS MANAGEMENT SYSTEM PROCUREMENT

- **2027 elections technology: IEBC ordered to review tender rules** — Daily Nation, 4 September 2026

  Review board finds the scoring methodology undisclosed and orders a re-issued tender, seven days minimum.

GOVERNMENT VEHICLE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **West African Governments Are Finally Tracking Their Own Vehicles** — Liberian Observer, 8 September 2026 LIBERIA

  Named-analyst column contrasting Kenya's Government Vehicle Management System with Liberia's untracked ministry fleet.

CITIZEN ADOPTION OF AND SATISFACTION WITH DIGITAL GOVERNMENT SERVICES

- **Kenyans among world's heaviest AI users, survey shows** — TechTrends Media Ltd, 10 September 2026

  BCG's 8th biennial citizen survey: Kenya 87% weekly AI use, 49% digital-government adoption.

MULTI-VENDOR ELECTRONIC SEALS UNDER THE REGIONAL CARGO TRACKING SYSTEM

- **Approved vendors for the electronic monitoring and tracking of goods under customs control and transition to the multi-vendor user-owned framework** — Kenya Revenue Authority, 11 September 2026

KRA-owned RECTS e-seals phased out by 26 October 2026; 15 approved vendors, list held off the notice.

- **KRA's unveils new system to boost cargo security and risk management** — The Standard, 15 September 2026

  Multi-vendor, user-owned electronic cargo seals replace KRA's government-owned system from 2026-10-26; 15 vendors.

- **Traders support revenue agency's multi-vendor cargo tracking system** — The Star (Kenya), 16 September 2026 EAST AFRICA

  Importers, exporters and logistics firms welcomed the Kenya Revenue Authority's decision to open the regional electronic cargo tracking system to private seal vendors. The Shippers Council of Eastern Africa expects competition to end seal shortages that have delayed transit cargo at Mombasa.

ONLINE DRIVING-LICENCE RENEWAL AND APPLICATION SERVICE

- **NTSA Clarifies System Hitch Affecting Driving Licenses** — Kenyans.co.ke, 11 September 2026

  Online renewals and first-time applications blocked; NTSA confirms fault on its end, gives no fix timeline.

DIGIKEN PROGRAMME

- **Kenya's DigiKen Programme Mobilises $4.26 Million for Digital Transformation** — Tech Africa News, 15 September 2026

  A multi-stakeholder digital programme carrying about US$4.26m in funding and co-financing supports fifteen innovation hubs in media and information literacy, digital skills, platform entrepreneurship and sustainable agriculture. Its steering committee reviewed progress.

HUDUMA CENTRES

- **Mwea residents get government services closer home with new Huduma Centre** — Kenya Broadcasting Corporation, 18 September 2026

  Kindiki commissions Kenya's 61st centre at Ngurubani, 2026-09-18; IDs, birth certificates, KRA; Jitume ICT hub on site.

PARTY AND OBSERVER ACCESS TO THE VOTER REGISTRATION SYSTEM'S SOURCE CODE AND AUDIT LOGS

- **Political parties, election observers to access IEBC voter register** — The Standard, 20 September 2026

  Kenyan political parties and election observers are to be given access to the source code and audit logs of the electoral commission's continuous voter registration system, following a court directive. The account is a free lede behind a paywall and names neither the court, the case nor the date of the directive.

KENYA DIASPORA IMPACT PLATFORM

- **Kenya, UN and Equity Sign Joint Declaration of Intent for the Kenya Diaspora Impact Platform Initiative** — State Department for Diaspora Affairs, Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Signed 20 Sept 2026 in New York by Mudavadi, UN RC Conille and Equity's Mwangi; no budget or launch date stated.

SERVICES AVAILABLE THROUGH ECITIZEN

- **Kenya Has 22,000 Digital Services but Still Face a Manual Backend** — Techweez, 23 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

- **UNGA81: Kenya proposes cross-border digital public service pilot for Africa** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

ELECTRONIC TRAVEL AUTHORISATION (ETA) SYSTEM

- **Mohammed & another v Ministry of Interior and National Administration & 4 others (Constitutional Petition E006 of 2026) [2026] KEHC 15080 (KLR) (5 October 2026) (Judgment)** — High Court of Kenya at Marsabit (Kenya Law), 5 October 2026

  Delivered 5 Oct 2026: eTA insurance-data privacy claims generalised and unproven; petition dismissed, no costs.

INSTANT FINES TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **Senate seeks clarity on traffic cameras and NTSA's automated fines** — Radio Generation, 9 October 2026

  Senate ICT committee quizzes NTSA chief on automated fines after March court halt; legal basis and data handling.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

NAKURU COUNTY GENDER-BASED VIOLENCE AND DISABILITY CASE MANAGEMENT PLATFORM

- **New Digital Platform Launched in Nakuru County to Improve Support for Survivors of Gender-Based Violence and Persons with Disabilities** — County Government of Nakuru, 22 September 2026

  Lithuania-funded GBV and disability case platform live; 54 GBV cases and 216 PWD applications logged so far.

COUNTY PAYROLL MIGRATION TO THE HUMAN RESOURCE INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **Revealed: Counties made Sh8.3bn manual payments outside payroll systems** — Daily Nation, 1 October 2026

  Controller of Budget, FY to June 2026: Nakuru Sh1.86bn (21.8%) manual; reasons incl. HRIS-Ke onboarding, connectivity.

Rural digital data capture

MKULIMA BORA AGRICULTURAL MARKETPLACE

- **From GovStack Principles to Practice: Connecting Kenyan Farmers with Markets through Mkulima Bora** — GovStack, 8 September 2026

  Kenya is piloting a digital agricultural marketplace across five Rift Valley counties, built on reusable components and open standards, with identity-verified onboarding and more than a thousand users.

Technology

AI

AI-GENERATED POLITICAL INFLUENCE OPERATION AHEAD OF THE 2027 ELECTION

- **'What matters is evidence!' Wandayi distances himself from AI campaign praising tariff move** — The Star, 11 September 2026

  Energy CS denies any ministry role in the Claude-generated #PowerReliefKE astroturfing network.

- **Anthropic flags Kenya AI influence operation** — ITWeb Africa, 11 September 2026

Names the report and its December 2025-August 2026 window; also a Bangui radio and a 70-site DRC network.

- **CS Wandayi Responds to Anthropic Report on AI-Generated Campaign Praising Him** — Kenyans.co.ke, 11 September 2026

  Wandayi: coordinated anonymous accounts are not evidence of government involvement; what matters is evidence.

- **Kenyan political operator used Claude to mass-produce election propaganda, Anthropic says** — TechCabal, 11 September 2026

  Batches of exactly 50 tweets praising CS Opiyo Wandayi; Breakout Scale Category One, no reach established.

KONZA DIGITAL MEDIA CITY AND AI DATA CENTRE

- **Kenya, South Korea Deepen Ksh129.4B development partnership** — People Daily Digital, 11 September 2026

  Summarised under Technical Capacity.

NATIONAL AI COMPUTING PLATFORM

- **Kenya, UNDP move to operationalise sovereign AI infrastructure at Konza Data Centre** — TechReview Africa, 11 September 2026

  UNDP Kenya and Technopolis Development Authority sign a Letter of Agreement for sovereign AI at Konza.

BANK USE OF AI IN CREDIT RISK ASSESSMENT

- **AI already decides who gets a loan in Kenya. Now decide who governs it** — Capital FM Kenya, 14 September 2026

  256 licensed digital credit providers have disbursed 8.37m loans worth over KES 150bn, decided by models.

- **Central Bank of Kenya - Bank Supervision Annual Report 2025** — Central Bank of Kenya, 22 September 2026

  Summarised under Standards.

OPENSCOPES AIDDIA AI MICROSCOPY PROGRAMME

- **R101m UCT project brings AI microscopy to Africa** — ITWeb South Africa, 23 September 2026

  SOUTH AFRICA | UGANDA | CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  The University of Cape Town launched openScopes AIDDiA, a four-year, Wellcome Trust-funded programme worth GBP 4.4 million (about R101 million) pairing open-source microscopy with machine-learning image analysis for research on TB, malaria and other infectious diseases. Partners are KEMRI, Uganda's Mbarara University, Côte d'Ivoire's CSRS and Imperial College London.

ROADMAP FOR CHILDREN'S RIGHTS AND PROTECTION IN THE AGE OF AI, 2026-2027

- **Ruto Calls for Safer AI and Technology for Children** — ynews.digital, 23 September 2026

  Coalition's 2026-2027 roadmap backed by 23 states; Kenya drafting an AI policy expected to cover child online safety.

- **UNGA81: Kenya joins global leaders to promote children's rights in the Age of AI** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

President Ruto co-hosted the launch of a 2026-2027 Roadmap for Children's Rights and Protection in the Age of AI at the UN General Assembly, alongside the leaders of France, Spain and Australia. Kenya's technology envoy Philip Thigo said Kenya would take the work forward at home, across Africa and globally.

DHOLUO SPEECH DATASET

- **MCAAI drives Dholuo speech data collection to improve AI representation** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

  The Maseno Centre for Applied Artificial Intelligence ran a preparatory visit to Suba ahead of collecting Dholuo speech data to improve the language's representation in AI systems, onboarding participants to its SmartVoice app. The work involves the ACTS-AI4D team.

HUB FOR AI AND DISABILITY INCLUSION AND AFRICAN DISABILITY DATA NETWORK

- **How Africa's AI boom is leaving 100 million disabled citizens behind** — TechCabal, 24 September 2026 GHANA AFRICA

  A Hub for AI and Disability Inclusion (HAIDI), hosted by KNUST's Responsible AI Lab, and an African Disability Data Network were launched at the Global Data Festival in Nairobi with backing from IDRC, the UK FCDO and AI4D. They plan to map disability-related datasets, build three new datasets, assess how national AI strategies treat disability and fund three startups with grants of up to KES 5 million.

MORAN AI CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE

- **Kenya and Cisco deepen partnership on AI skills, cybersecurity and digital transformation** — Tech Review Africa, 28 September 2026

  Kenya's President and technology envoy discussed with Cisco the Moran AI Centre of Excellence, being developed with the defence forces as a regional hub for AI and cybersecurity, alongside AI skills for young people.

ICT Industry

FIBRE OPERATOR REPOSITIONING INTO AI AND CLOUD SERVICES

- **Interview: Liquid bets on AI as next growth frontier for Africa's fibre network** — TechTrends KE, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  The same operator is repositioning from connectivity provider to a layered artificial intelligence, cloud and cybersecurity business on top of its fibre backbone, its vice-president and chief executive said at a Nairobi conference. Connectivity becomes the foundation of digital infrastructure rather than the product, he argued, naming data-centre capacity as the concern African telecom executives raise most.

- **Interview: Liquid targets Africa's data centre gap** — ITWeb Africa, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  A pan-African fibre operator's Kenyan chief executive says the continent's data-centre capacity is becoming a major concern for African telecom executives, as the business pushes deeper into artificial intelligence and cloud services. He puts Africa at 0.6 per cent of the world's data-centre capacity.

GOVERNMENT SALE OF A 15% STAKE IN THE LARGEST TELCO

- **Kenya's High Court voids Vodacom's $1.5 billion Safaricom takeover** — TechCabal, 15 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

A three-judge High Court bench voided the government's sale of a 15 per cent Safaricom stake, a KES 204.3bn transaction that closed less than three months earlier, ruling it unconstitutional because key information was withheld from the public, the cabinet and parliament.

- **Vodacom's Safaricom deal struck down by Kenyan high court** — TechCentral, 15 September 2026
  SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under New investments.

- **Safaricom ruling crucial** — Daily Nation, 16 September 2026

  Petitioners put the shares at Sh70 against the Sh34 sale price; 6 billion shares ordered back to the state.

- **Vodacom, Kenya to appeal court ruling voiding Safaricom sale** — Connecting Africa, 16 September 2026
  SOUTH AFRICA

  Vodacom and Kenya's Treasury both said on 16 September 2026 that they will appeal the High Court ruling that voided the sale of a 15% government stake in Safaricom. The court found the deal lacked meaningful public participation and hid material information, and ordered the stake returned to the state.

M-KOPA ACQUISITION OF A DEVICE-LOCKING SOFTWARE COMPANY

- **M-KOPA acquires Finnish device-locking company KilpiTek Oy for $8 million** — TechCabal, 7 October 2026

  M-KOPA's financial statements show it completed the US$8m acquisition of a Finnish device-locking software company on 26 March 2026, US$2.67m of it in cash. The purchase brings in-house the technology that restricts financed smartphones when customers fall behind.

MICROSOFT AFRICA DEVELOPMENT CENTRE, NAIROBI

- **Microsoft to shut Nairobi engineering centre, putting hundreds of jobs at risk** — TechCabal, 13 October 2026

  Microsoft is winding down its Africa Development Centre in Nairobi, staff were told on 12 October, putting nearly 400 jobs at risk with fewer than 10 expected to remain. The company confirmed only proposed changes to its engineering operations; Kenya's ICT Cabinet Secretary, briefed the same day, agreed a joint action plan with it.

- **Microsoft's Nairobi Development Centre Faces Possible Closure** — Kenyans.co.ke, 13 October 2026

  Microsoft plans to close the engineering department of its Africa Development Centre in Nairobi after more than seven years, a Kenyan outlet reports. Between 400 and 500 employees could be affected.

Innovation ecosystem

WORKKE ONLINE WORK PLATFORM

- **Avec WorkKE, le Kényan Kennedy Mokaya démocratise le travail en ligne en Afrique** — wearetech.africa, 8 September 2026

  WorkKE, a Kenyan platform launched in 2024, matches businesses to freelancers and uses local cybercafes as access relays, releasing escrow-held payments as project stages are validated and settling over mobile money. It reports more than 1,650 registered users, over 500 of them freelancers, and 200 partner cybercafes, and is extending into Uganda, Tanzania, Nigeria, South Africa and Ghana; the counts are the company's own.

Capacity

Literacy

DIGITAL LITERACY PROGRAMME

- **Kenya : 1000 diplômés en TIC recrutés pour soutenir la numérisation des écoles** — wearetech.africa, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's Public Service Commission opened applications on 15 September 2026 for 1,000 ICT graduates to spend 12 months in schools and sub-county education offices supporting the Digital Literacy Programme. Applications close on 5 October 2026.

- **Kenya Begins Digital Literacy Programme Phase II Device Rollout in Nairobi** — Tech Africa News, 16 September 2026

  Kenya began the second phase of its Digital Literacy Programme, putting teacher laptops and interactive smartboards into 10,382 public junior schools. In Nairobi all 98 targeted schools had devices and 91 had completed installation and acceptance.

- **Kenya Deploys Smart Boards to 178 Public Junior Schools in Nyeri** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Kenya began delivering smart boards and teacher laptops to 178 public junior schools in Nyeri County on 21 September, under phase II of the Digital Literacy Programme. The programme is funded through the World Bank-supported Kenya Digital Economy Acceleration Project and is to reach all 377 junior schools in the county.

- **Kenya ICT Authority Expands Digital Learning Rollout to 377 Junior Schools in Nyeri** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  The ICT Authority's account of the same Nyeri rollout adds that more than 62,000 teachers nationally have already been trained under the Digital Literacy Programme.

AI FOR CITIZENS PROGRAMME (PUBLIC LIBRARIES)

- **Kenya and Intel Partner to Expand AI Literacy Through Public Libraries** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Kenya's State Department of ICT signed a partnership with Intel at the UN General Assembly to teach AI literacy through public libraries. It will run through the Kenya National Library Service and the Mandela AI Hub Foundation under Intel's AI for Citizens programme.

Training and skills

RESPONSIBLE AI USE IN COMPETENCY-BASED STEM TEACHING

- **CEMASTEA champions responsible AI use in competency-based STEM education** — Kenya News Agency, 4 September 2026

  CEMASTEA workshop, 3-4 September 2026, 100 teachers; acting CEO warns against AI dependence in classrooms.

SHECONNECTS EMPOWERHER DIGITAL ACCELERATOR

- **KICTANet SheConnects EmpowerHer Digital Accelerator — Tana River Trainer of Trainers** — KICTANet, 9 September 2026

  Three-day workshop in Tana River County, 9-11 September 2026, building 100 trainers for a women's digital curriculum.

KFW DIGITALISATION OF VOCATIONAL TRAINING

- **D4TVET Tender 2026 - Prequalification of Implementation Consultant** — Tenderyetu, 22 September 2026

  KfW, AFD and EU co-finance some EUR 50m for TVET digitalisation; five-year implementation consultant sought.

DATA CENTRE ACADEMY FOR ENGINEERING GRADUATES

- **IBTC Expands Data Centre Academy to Kenya with Schneider Support** — Startup Kenya, 23 September 2026

  Launched at ITW & Datacloud Africa Nairobi; first cohort five iXAfrica staff; EU-co-funded Digital Investment Facility.

JITUME DIGITAL ENABLEMENT PROGRAMME

- **Kenya Commissions Jitume ICT Hub in Uasin Gishu as Digital Network Reaches 391 Sites** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026

  Kenya commissioned a Jitume ICT hub at a technical training campus in Uasin Gishu, taking the national network to 391 equipped sites and 23,387 devices. Of 253 technical and vocational institutions, 186 have the equipment and 67 still wait.

KENYA SCHOOL OF GOVERNMENT ELEARNING AND INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY INSTITUTE (ELITI)

- **Kenya Launches KSG Digital Institute as 1,239 Public Officers Graduate in AI Training** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026

  The Kenya School of Government launched an eLearning and Information Technology Institute as 1,239 public officers graduated from a UNESCO-Oxford programme on artificial intelligence and digital transformation in government.

Research institutions

RESEARCH ON ALTERNATIVE MEDIA AND ELECTION MISINFORMATION

- **Kenya Alternative Media Report Warns Of Election Misinformation** — KICTANet, 9 September 2026

  Many Microphones, Little Accountability: KICTANet on Facebook, TikTok, YouTube and X ahead of the 2027 general election.

CIVIL-SOCIETY SUBMISSIONS ON ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE INSTRUMENTS

- **CIPESA Weighs in on Kenya's Draft Guidance Notes on AI and Emerging Technologies** — CIPESA, 24 September 2026

  Asks for biometric DPIAs, audits of feed algorithms and state-use oversight; warns adequacy tests risk localisation.

Inclusion

Access to services

CHILDREN EXPOSED TO UNWANTED SEXUAL CONTENT ONLINE

- **When the danger comes through a child's phone: One in five children exposed to sexual content online** — Daily Nation, 5 September 2026

  UNICEF report: one million Kenyan children exposed to unwanted sexual content online, third-highest rate measured.

DIGITAL LEARNING INITIATIVE IN PUBLIC JUNIOR SCHOOLS

- **Kenya Expands Digital Learning Initiative to 10,384 Public Junior Schools** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  Kenya is extending its digital learning initiative to 10,384 public junior schools, distributing smartboards and laptops, digitising curriculum content and training teachers. It is run by the ICT ministry through its authority, with the education ministry, the curriculum development institute and the teachers' service commission.

Digital divides

PAY-AS-YOU-GO SMARTPHONE FINANCING MARKET

- **Sun King joins Kenya's growing smartphone financing race** — TechCabal, 4 September 2026

  Sun King began selling financed smartphones in Kenya, entering the market M-KOPA and Watu built. Its handset is sold only on a pay-as-you-go contract - a KES 2,299 deposit and KES 55 a day for 365 days, KES 22,374 in all - repaid through the phone's own lock screen, app, SIM toolkit or USSD, with the device locked if payments stop. The company opened a Tatu City assembly plant with capacity for 700,000 units a year in October 2025.

DIGITAL SKILLS PROGRAMME FOR REFUGEE AND HOST-COMMUNITY YOUTH, GARISSA AND TURKANA

- **Garissa Refugee Youth Get Digital Skills Training** — CIO Africa, 11 September 2026

  1,700 youth targeted in Garissa and Turkana; 700 enrolled, 1,000 Microsoft vouchers, Dutch PROSPECTS money.

- **Kenya: 1,700 Youth in Garissa, Turkana to Get Digital Skills Training** — Capital FM (Nairobi), via allAfrica.com, 11 September 2026

  1,700 refugee and host-community youth across 37 hubs; Microsoft adds up to 1,000 certification vouchers.

- **Power Learn Project Trains 1,700 Youth in Kenya AI, Cloud Skills** — TechMoran, 11 September 2026

  1,700 youth across Garissa and Turkana; 700 already enrolled, 35% women, up to 1,000 Microsoft vouchers.

Data

National statistics

NATIONAL SURVEY ON CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION AND SAFETY

- **Kenya Reviews National Survey Findings on Child Online Protection and Safety** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya and the University of Nairobi's Institute for Development Studies have begun reviewing preliminary findings from a joint national survey on children's online experiences and safety, agreeing the report structure and thematic areas ahead of validation. The authority says the findings are intended as the evidence base for regulatory interventions on child online protection; nothing has been published yet.

INCLUSIVE DATA CHARTER ACTION PLAN 2026-2030

- **Kenya's second IDC Action Plan expands the country's commitments to inclusive data** — Global Partnership for Sustainable Development Data, 8 October 2026

  Kenya drafted its second Inclusive Data Charter action plan, for 2026 to 2030, at a workshop on 5 to 7 October. It widens the first plan's focus on disability to gender, children and older persons.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

MEMORANDUM WITH THE HOOVER INSTITUTION'S EMERGING MARKETS WORKING GROUP

- **Kenya, Hoover Institution sign AI data pact** — ITWeb Africa, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's foreign ministry signed a five-year memorandum of understanding with the Emerging Markets Working Group at Stanford's Hoover Institution during the UN General Assembly in New York. The signing date was not given. The first project is an El Niño monitoring and response system that brings climate, geospatial, water, farming and infrastructure data together by county. Later work is to include a digital trade readiness index and a tracker for public-private partnerships.

JOINT DECLARATION WITH ANTHROPIC

- **Kenya signs AI deal with Claude AI to boost public-sector skills** — The Standard, 23 September 2026

  Kenya signed a Joint Declaration with Anthropic in New York during UNGA 81, covering AI applications in education and health, research, capacity building, and AI safety and evaluation. The next step is to develop specific pilots and institutional partnerships with government agencies.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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